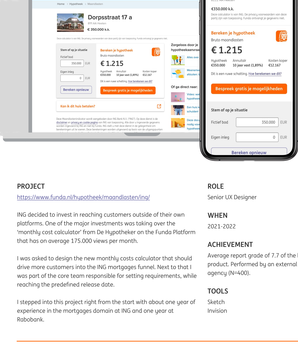
Designing a monthly mortgage costs calculator used on an external platform



PROJECT
https://www.funda.nl/hypotheek/maandlasten/ing/

ING decided to invest in reaching customers outside of their own platforms. One of the major investments was taking over the 'monthly cost calculator' from De Hypotheker on the Funda Platform that has on average 175.000 views per month.

I was asked to design the new monthly costs calculator that should drive more customers into the ING mortgages funnel. Next to that I was part of the core team responsible for setting requirements, while reaching the predefined release date.

I stepped into this project right from the start with about one year of experience in the mortgages domain at ING and one year at Rabobank.

ROLE
Senior UX Designer

WHEN
2021-2022

ACHIEVEMENT
Average report grade of 7.7 of the live product. Performed by an external agency (NI+400).

TOOLS
Sketch
Invision

The process

0-MEASUREMENT CURRENT PRODUCT
We did research on the reactions to the current monthly costs calculator from our competitor De Hypotheker. The end result section that follows shows changes made.

CLARIFY CUSTOMER JOURNEY
To clarify the customer journey I planned a 'Scope Canvas' workshop with the core team. The goal of the workshop is to define the parameters of a product and get everybody on the same page.

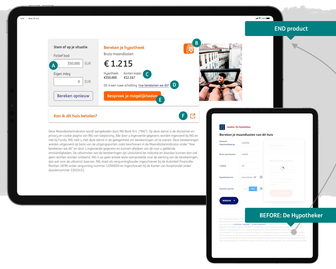
BRAINSTORM & ITERATE
From the 0-measurement the user requirements became clear, but the business- and feasibility requirements were still fuzzy. To solve this I started off with putting as many ideas as possible on paper to make it easier to let the requirements surface and enthousiasm rise.

USABILITY TESTING
Tested the agreed upon product through on Invision prototype. Invision protrage and research setup was done by me, but research itself was performed by an external agency.

FINALIZE
Based on the research findings I could finalize all interactions, product visuals and pixel specifications to get it ready for development.

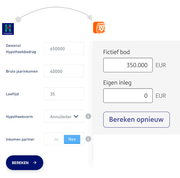
PROUD MOMENT
I decided on a research schedule of two days with two days in between, to quickly iterate and test. We got to validate our changes!

The end product



A CHANGED ALL INPUT FIELDS
Most input fields De Hypotheker used were not needed to make the calculations. So we took them out.

Users missed the option to fill in own money or surplus house value. To make that possible we split wanted mortgage input (gewenste hypotheekbedrag) into two fields: fictive bid and own money.



B BRANDING IN CALCULATOR
Space was valuable on mobile devices, because it was framed in after a big header of funda. We wanted at least the primary CTA to fit in the screen, even on older devices.

So I designed it with the logo inside of the result section. And on bigger devices I added the option to show a brand image next to the result. I suggested a photo that looks back to the result to circle eye movement back to the follow-up actions.

C ADD MISSING INFORMATION
User wanted to know 'kosten koper'. 'Kosten koper' are the additional costs that come with buying a house (notary cost for example). This information gives users the option to see if they have enough savings or see how much is left to put into the house.

D SOLVING I-FRAME RESTRICTIONS
Because the calculator was framed into the Funda page it wasn't possible to make use of dialogs. To work around that I solved it inline by replacing the content of the card and adding back navigation. This to make it feel like a side-step navigation, so that users don't loose direction.

E CONTACT FORM
Business was afraid that too many calls would be planned in, therefor (too) much business logic was requested. Together with the core team I tried to keep the logic to a minimum and we came to an agreement on:

Sending ING customer to the logged in environment, where they could plan it in themselves.

And letting none ING customers fill in a form and let them be called back at a moment an ING employee had time. With an urgency question to sort incoming requests based on how urgent the lead is.

Update
On Funda you will now find an even more simplified contact form. With that part I wasn't involved anymore.

F DOWN THE RABBIT HOLE
Most users are actually not ready to make an appointment at the moment they use this page. Most are still in their orientation phase.

To keep users going down the rabbit hole with ING we decided to give them the option to calculate if they can buy the house they spotted and did a monthly cost calculation for.

For this we decided to send them to the ING website. This has benefits for usability and business purposes, because we have full control (instead of being framed into a website).

On that website they will see a new calculator that re-uses the input they already filled in on Funda and they only need to answer their income(s).

After that we try to let them continue with other mortgage orientation tools or making an appointment.

Update
This functionality isn't live yet. Currently users are send to the mva mortgage calculator.

The end